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Every Diwali, people all across the country indulge and spend on purchases of all kinds – food, decorations, house renovations, furniture, household appliances, you name it. The folks at Digit are most excited about the festive season too. I, for one, have no plans to go out shopping for fancy curtains and footwear. As always, I'm most eager to see what consumer electronics goodies I can get some deals on. I also have geeky friends who expect me to find good deals.

In the last couple of years, Indians have splurged on gadgets and consumer electronics like never before. Every festive season through the year, manufacturers make large price cuts on some of their products. Newspapers, sites and TV channels are flooded with offers and discounts of all kinds. Walk into a mall, and you'll see more than the usual share of hoardings and

advertisements showing off the offers and discounts. Obviously, everyone is excited to buy something or the other.

What's wrong with that?

Nothing, really. So long as you understand that companies don't suddenly go soft and decide to take huge losses to make your holiday a festive one by offering killer deals. It's a numbers game, and although you will get gadgets for cheaper, most of the time, there are still times you might end up paying *more* than you usually would!

Now before you think I've gone stark-raving mad, or call me a con-

spiracy theorist, all I ask is that you read the whole article and decide for yourself whether I'm as crazy as you think. I just might be able to save you some money, or at least help you buy better products for the same price.

It's not like these companies are evil, and looking to cheat you out of your hard earned cash; it's just that everyone's trying to outdo each other in terms of the deals they put on offer. There are even instances when companies sell you older models, in sort of a stock clearing sale. Yes there are good deals to be had here, but if you think you're getting top of the

Maybe you shouldn't buy right now...

As much as we'd like to believe that prices are dropping and there are plenty of amazing deals on the web and in the shopping malls, it's not easy to find a deal that is actually amazing. For example, if you are looking to buy a laptop, and you want something expensive, it may be wiser to wait till the festival period ends. You might find that post the festival season, prices actually fall. Why? For one all those "bundle offers" will have gone away, meaning that the manufacturers are not trying to palm off stuff in bundles, and you will actually pay for the price of the product you want. Also, sometimes companies produce or import more than they can sell, and this results in a surplus, which obviously means cheaper prices...